of Roman ascendancy, the Phalanx had reached the zenith of its development. The front ranks now used a shortened, 9-foot spear, while the fifth rank used an immense 21-footer, with the length of the sarissa of intervening ranks of corresponding lengths. This allowed the Phalanx to present an almost impenetrable wall of spears. Tangentially, as a Roman legionary needed room to swing his sword while the phalangite simply had to remain in place, the ratio of spears to legionary was often (and usually) 10-1!! The trick (and the catch) was the Phalanx remaining in place! The make-up of a Phalanx often varied from country to country, depending on weapon type and training. The ultimate decider, in game terms, was how they were trained tactically.